Paragraph writing
English II

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What is a Paragraph?



What is a Paragraph?

A paragraph is a group of sentences about one particular topic or idea. It provides specific information on the topic. A good paragraph will not include irrelevant sentences. It will focus on the main idea.

Pre-writing techniques

- Free writing
- Scratch Outline
- Clustering
- Questioning

TRANSITIONAL_EXPRESSIONS

- **Similarity** : also, in the same way, just as … so too, likewise, similarly
- **Exception/Contrast**: but, however, in spite of, on the one hand … on the other hand, nevertheless, nonetheless, notwithstanding, in contrast, on the contrary, still, yet
- **Sequence/Order:** first, second, third, … next, then, finally

- **Time:** after, afterward, at last, before, currently, during, earlier, immediately, later, meanwhile, now, recently, simultaneously, subsequently, then
- **Example:** for example, for instance, namely, specifically, to illustrate
- **Emphasis:** even, indeed, in fact, of course, truly

- **Place/Position** above, adjacent, below, beyond, here, in front, in back, nearby, there
- **Cause and Effect** accordingly, consequently, hence, so, therefore, thus
- **Additional Support or Evidence** :additionally, again, also, and, as well, besides, equally important, further, furthermore, in addition, moreover, then
- **Conclusion/summary** : finally, in a word, in brief, briefly, in conclusion, in the end, in the final analysis, on the whole, thus, to conclude, to summarize, in sum, to sum up, in summary

The Structure of a Paragraph

- **There are three parts of a paragraph:**

- A topic sentence (introduction/beginning)
- Supporting sentences (body/middle)
- A concluding sentence (end/ conclusion)

Part 1: Topic sentence

- **The topic sentence is usually the first sentence in a paragraph.** It tells the reader what the **main idea of the paragraph is**. In the topic sentence, the controlling idea which will be discussed in the paragraph is mentioned.

- A good topic sentence should be clear and simple. It can be further explained, supported or proven too. The topic sentence should make the reader ask a question; for example: **What**, **Where**, **When**, **Why** or **How**?

Topic sentence sample:

- Online classes have become one of the most convenient ways of learning

- **Topic**: Online classes
- **Controlling idea**: have become one of the most convenient ways of learning

Topic sentence sample:

- The FIFA World Cup is one of the most exciting sporting events in the world.

- Topic: The FIFA World Cup
- Controlling idea: is one of the most exciting sporting events in the world

Part 2: Supporting Sentences

- The supporting sentences give **explanation**, **evidences** and **opinion** to support the main idea of the paragraph. Therefore, all supporting sentences should help the reader to understand the topic and focus on the topic sentence better.

Supporting details

- It is important to review what is relevant and irrelevant while writing the supporting sentences. One should be careful and judge if each of the sentences helps him/her strengthen the point of the paragraph. Otherwise, the purpose of the paragraph will not be effective.

Supporting Details

Topic: Online class

- Students can attend classes from any location.
- They save time and money by avoiding daily travel.
- Recorded lectures allow students to review lessons whenever needed.

- **Supporting Detail 1:**Students can attend classes from any location.
- **Explanation/Illustration**: **For example**, a student who lives in a village can join the same class as a student living in Dhaka without traveling to the university.

- **Supporting Detail 2:**They save time and money by avoiding daily travel.
- **Explanation/Illustration**: Students do not need to spend money on bus fares or fuel, and they can use the saved time for studying or completing assignments.

- **Supporting Detail 3:** Recorded lectures allow students to review lessons whenever needed.
- **Explanation/Illustration**: For instance, if a student misses an important grammar rule during class, they can watch the recording again before an exam.

Supporting details

Topic: The FIFA World Cup

- It brings together the best football teams from different countries.
- Millions of fans watch the matches with great enthusiasm.
- The tournament promotes sportsmanship and international unity.

- **Supporting Detail 1:**It brings together the best football teams from different countries.
- **Explanation/Illustration**: For example, teams like Brazil, Argentina, Germany, France, and Spain compete against one another, making every tournament highly competitive.

- **Supporting Detail 2:**Millions of fans watch the matches with great enthusiasm.
- **Explanation/Illustration**: Many people gather with their families and friends to watch the games, while others celebrate victories by waving flags and cheering for their favorite teams.

- **Supporting Detail 3:**The tournament promotes sportsmanship and international unity.
- **Explanation/Illustration**: Players from different cultures respect one another, and fans from around the world come together to celebrate their shared love of football.

Part 3: Concluding Sentence

- The concluding sentence is in the last part of the paragraph. It may restate the main idea of the paragraph. The concluding sentence may also give a short summary of what have been said in the paragraph.

Concluding sentence :

- Topic Sentence: Online classes have become one of the most convenient ways of learning.
- Concluding Sentence: In conclusion, online classes have made education more accessible and flexible for many learners.

Concluding sentence :

- Topic Sentence: The FIFA World Cup is one of the most exciting sporting events in the world.
- Concluding Sentence: Therefore, the FIFA World Cup continues to inspire and entertain football fans across the globe.

Thus, a paragraph is like a **sandwich**. The topic and concluding sentences are the pieces of bread on the top and bottom, and the supporting sentences are the meat and cheese in the middle.

When we write a paragraph, we use the topic sentence to tell our reader what we are going to say. Then we use the supporting sentences to say what we want to affirm. We may also add a final comment to the readers if we want. All of these are complementary to one another. Every paragraph in good academic writing uses the three-part structure.